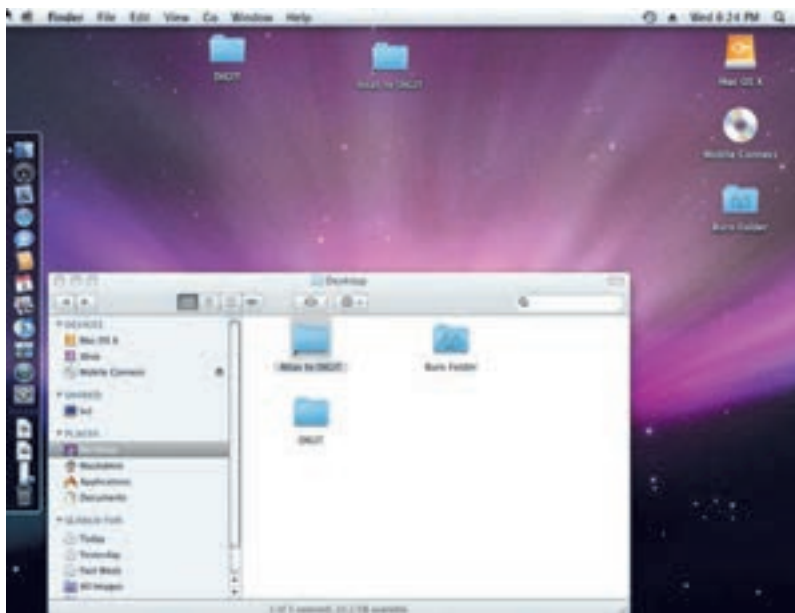


3.1.1 The finder



The standard finder window with two just created folders

The finder is the replacement of Windows Explorer in Windows or Nautilus in Gnome or Konqueror in KDE albeit with slightly different functionality of each, and it is quintessential that you become ninja with Finder to become a ninja on a Mac. To launch it either you can click on its icon [a very distinctive one with a face on it] on the Dock or you can just even click on some empty space on the Desktop. A finder window is so important to the working of the Mac that it is always running in the background and is also the first icon on the Dock.

We shall start with describing the array of buttons you find on the top bar of the Finder window.

1.Back and Forward Buttons: Very self explanatory, they allow you to go back and forward in your directory listing. Very useful when you want to reach a top level directory quickly.

2.View Controls: You have four options over here, the default 'Icon View', 'List View', 'Column View' and 'Cover Flow'. Column view is the counterpart